



Warm-up

Which is your favourite place in your home?

Speak about it in class.



I might have lived inside a **shell**

If I had been a snail.



Or in a great, wide **tossing** sea

If I had been a whale.

Or in a noisy, busy hive

If I had been a bee.

Or a bunny in a burrow

Eating lettuce for my tea.



I might have had a kennel home

If I had been a dog.

Or a mud hole in a river **bank**

If I had been a frog.

I might have been a tiny bird

And lived inside a nest.

But oh! I'm glad I'm just a child

I think my home is best.



shell

tossing

bank

the hard outer covering of an animal

moving up and down

(here) land along the sides of a river





Understanding the Poem

(reading for main ideas)

A. Complete these sentences. Check your answers.

- | | |
|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. A snail lives in a... | 2. A whale lives in a... |
| 3. A bee lives in a... | 4. A bunny lives in a... |
| 5. A frog lives in a... | 6. A bird lives in a... |

B. Find the words in the poem which mean the same as these words. Check your answers with your teacher.

- | | | | |
|----------|----------|----------|-----------|
| 1. large | 2. small | 3. happy | 4. active |
|----------|----------|----------|-----------|

C. Answer these questions. Share your answers with your partner.

Find out if your partner is missing any important point.

1. Is the poem talking about a grown-up or a child? Give reasons.
2. What words have been used to describe the sea?

D. Think and answer.



(reading for inference; HOTS)

1. Why does the poet say that the hive was 'busy' and 'noisy'?
2. Make a list of reasons why we need homes.

E. Discuss in class.



kindness, community-living



(value-based question)

Not everyone is lucky to have a home. Some people cannot afford their own homes. Some homes are destroyed by war or by earthquakes and floods. People without homes are called 'homeless'. Discuss ways in which we can help them.



Appreciation

A. Go through the poem once again and pick out the pairs of rhyming words from the poem. Check your answers.

Note how lines beginning with 'If' and 'Or' add to the effect the poem has. This is known as **repetition**.

B. Read the poem out aloud and pick out instances of repetition. With the help of your teacher find out why certain words are repeated in poems.

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